a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

GRADE 8 · MARKETING PACK

How We Talk About This Year

Elevator pitch, parent + teacher one-pagers, social copy, taglines.

Year theme: Measure, Improve, Operate Smarter

CONTENTS

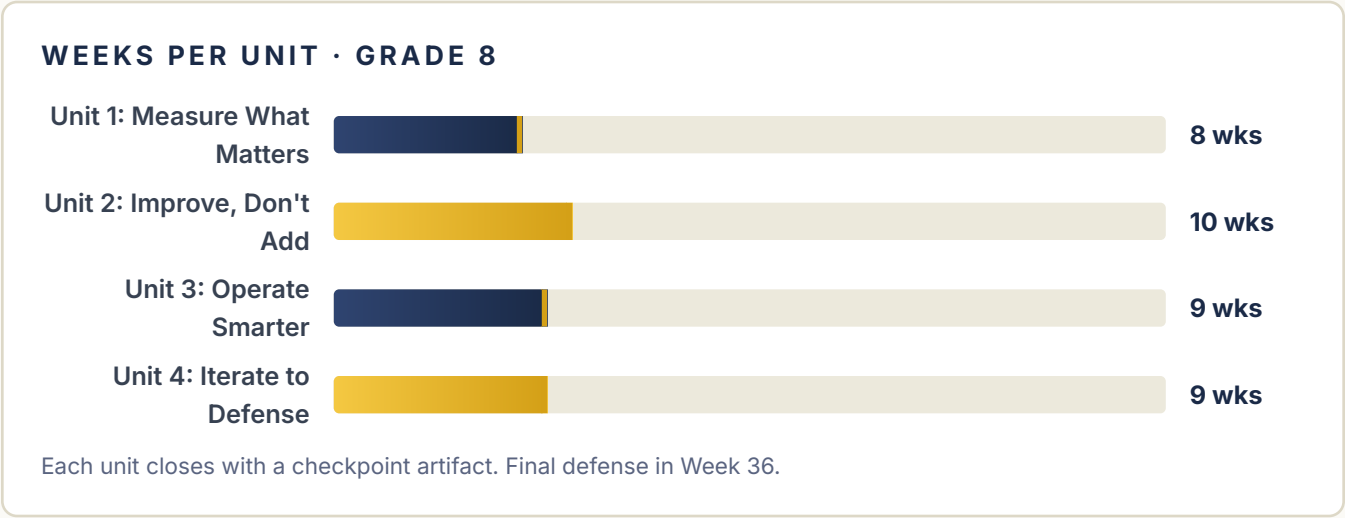
What's Inside

01 3-line elevator pitch
02 Parent-facing one-pager
03 Teacher-facing one-pager
04 Admin pitch outline
05 Hashtag bank (22)
06 Sample social posts

YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 8 · MARKETING PACK

How We Talk About This Year

A little less wrong, every week.

Year theme: Measure, improve, and operate smarter **Band:** 6-8 (band closer) · **Audience:** 8th-grader · parent · teacher · admin

3-line elevator pitch

"Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken."

— CASH

"Cash to Company eighth grade closes the middle-school band. Your 13-year-old learns to measure (break-even, variance), test (A/B), and operate smarter (SOPs, funnels). Year 9 of a continuous K-12 mascot arc — no hustle, mascot-led, the year before high-school Capstones."

Parent-facing one-pager

"You don't have to know everything. You have to know one number."

— CASH

What 8th grade covers

- **From idea to test** — pre-launch experimentation.
- **The break-even truth** — find the customer count that crosses the line.
- **Marketing as experiment** — A/B testing.
- **Operate smarter** — SOPs and process improvement.
- **Personas through the funnel** — top/middle/bottom-of-funnel.
- **A/B test biases** — what your test cannot tell you.
- **Variance is the story** — budget vs. actual.
- **Year-end Operate-Smarter Summary** — Capstone defense.

Dinner-table earworms

- "Smarter operations don't look impressive. They look quiet."
- "Variance is the story your business is trying to tell you."

- "Most adults skip this. You won't."

Promise: never asks family money. Never promises wealth.

What to say when...

- "My break-even is 47 customers/month." — "That's specific. How will you know when you're at 30?"
- "This isn't fair." — "What's the variance? What's the story?"

Teacher-facing one-pager

"Which people, and how do you know?"

— CASH

Year in 5 sentences

G8 is the **band closer** preparing students for high-school Capstones. Across 36 weeks, students design pre-launch tests, compute break-even, run A/B marketing experiments, write SOPs, map a funnel by persona, analyze A/B bias, compute variances, and present an Operate-Smarter Summary. Capstone: a system, a break-even, an A/B result, a variance story.

Standards

- CCSS-Math.8.F (functions), 8.SP (statistical patterns)
- CCSS-ELA.SL.8.1, W.8.1 (arguments, evidence)
- C3.D2.Eco.6-8.5/.6 (productivity, decisions)
- Jump$tart 6-8
- CASEL all 5

Weekly rhythm

Monday Cash + Q · Wed work block 60 min · Friday demo + retro 20 min.

The 8 Cash-video CTAs

1. **V1 (W1)** Riskiest assumption + 7-day test plan.
2. **V2 (W9)** Compute YOUR break-even. Defend it.
3. **V3 (W19)** Run a 3-day, 2-message A/B test.

4. **V4 (W29)** Standardize one process — SOP draft.
5. **V5 (W6)** Map your funnel. Persona at each stage.
6. **V6 (W26)** Two sentences on bias.
7. **V7 (W32)** Compute one variance + write the story.
8. **V8 (W36)** Defense Day — variance + SOP + funnel.

What to say when...

- "This is too hard." — "Where exactly? Let's find the one ratio you can compute."
- "My family doesn't have money for this." — "This is hypothetical Capstone math. Use simulated numbers."

Admin pitch outline

> *"Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal."*
>
> — CASH

1. **Outcomes:** every G8 student computes break-even, runs A/B test with bias analysis, writes a SOP, maps a funnel by persona, computes one variance story.
2. **Standards:** CCSS-Math 8.F/SP, ELA.SL.8.1/W.8.1, C3.D2.Eco.6-8.5/.6, Jump$tart, CASEL.
3. **Equity:** sensitivity policy enforced; equity-by-design.
4. **Evidence:** Fall 2026 pilot.
5. **Differentiator:** NGPF is HS-only; we close middle school inside the K-12 arc. JA is event-shaped; we are routine-shaped. EVERFI is sponsor-funded; we have no sponsor.

Hashtag bank (22)

`#CashToCompany` `#LearnWithCash` `#CashSays` `#MostAdultsSkipThis` `#EighthGrade` `#8thGrade` `#8thGradeTeacher` `#MiddleSchool` `#MiddleSchoolTeacher` `#TeachersOfInstagram` `#TeacherTok` `#FinLitTeacher` `#FinancialLiteracy` `#EntrepreneurshipForKids` `#BreakEven` `#ABTesting` `#VarianceAnalysis` `#OperateSmarter` `#ParentingTok` `#NoHustleParenting` `#CTEteacher` `#WhichPeopleAndHowDoYouKnow`

Sample social posts

Kid-direct

1. "My 8th grader just told me 'mom, smarter operations don't LOOK impressive, they look quiet.' Bro that's the most adult thing he's ever said." + V4 Short.
2. "My kid ran a 3-day A/B test on the school bulletin board. 'Mom — A won, but A was on the bigger wall.' BIAS ANALYSIS in 8th grade. (Cash to Company V6.)"
3. "'Variance is the story your business is trying to tell you.' My eighth grader. To my breakfast. Tagging @CashToCompany — what did you put in V7." + V7 Short.

Parent-direct

1. "Cash to Company eighth grade has my kid computing break-even points and doing variance analysis. He's 13. K-12, one mascot. (Yes, the mascot is a coin.)"
2. "The version of business education I want my kid to have: substantive, evidence-based, no hustle, no 'crush it.' Cash to Company is doing it."
3. "Cash never says 'side hustle.' Cash says 'side venture.' Sometimes brand discipline IS the brand."

Teacher-direct

1. "V2 — Break-Even Truth — half my class realized they couldn't even GET the inputs. Best 'realization' day of the year." + V2 Short.
2. "My 8th grade just ran a 3-day A/B test on real bulletin boards with real tallies. The bias-analysis V6 is what makes them think like adults."
3. "'Operate smarter, look boring, win.' Pinned to my classroom wall." + V4 Short.

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."

— CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 8 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 8 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist. The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-1	Identify the components of decision-making and apply them to financial decisions.
CCSS-Math 8.SP.A.1	Construct and interpret scatter plots for bivariate measurement data.
CCSS-ELA SL.8.4	Present claims and findings, emphasizing salient points in a focused, coherent manner.
C3 D2.Eco.5.6-8	Explain ways in which money facilitates exchange.
CASEL Responsible Decision-Making	Demonstrate curiosity and open-mindedness; analyze information.
CCSS-Math 7.RP.A.3	Use proportional relationships to solve multistep ratio and percent problems.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

> *"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."*
>
> — CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Measure What Matters

Priya runs a tutoring micro-business helping 6th graders with pre-algebra. She has eight regular clients. Five say they would recommend her. Three would not. Her old metric was "hours billed." Her new metric: "would recommend."

The new metric tells a different story. Two of her three non-recommenders share the same complaint: "Sessions feel like quizzes." Priya redesigns the first 10 minutes of every session to start with what the student is stuck on, not what Priya wants to teach. Three weeks later: 7 of 8 would recommend.

What changed? Not effort. Not skill. The metric. "Would recommend" surfaced the experience. Hours billed surfaced nothing.

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

> *"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."*
>
> — CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH, GRADE 8